

Software on the radio

Merlin says it demonstrated AI-powered air traffic control communications at TxDOT's Project Nexus kickoff on September 10th. Neither TxDOT's release nor the FAA's names Merlin. The plane is drawn to illustrate.



Phase one began here

The Texas Department of Transportation launched the first phase of Project Nexus at Fort Worth Alliance Airport, as part of a federal pilot program for new aircraft. The FAA called it the first Texas demonstration under the program. The tower and the radio path are drawn to illustrate.



Two Caravans, by two companies' word

Merlin's release pictures its Caravan at Alliance Airport. Joby said J208, a Caravan with its autonomous flight technology, would stop there on September 10th. Each release speaks for its own aircraft. Both are drawn to illustrate, unmarked.



JOBY'S J208

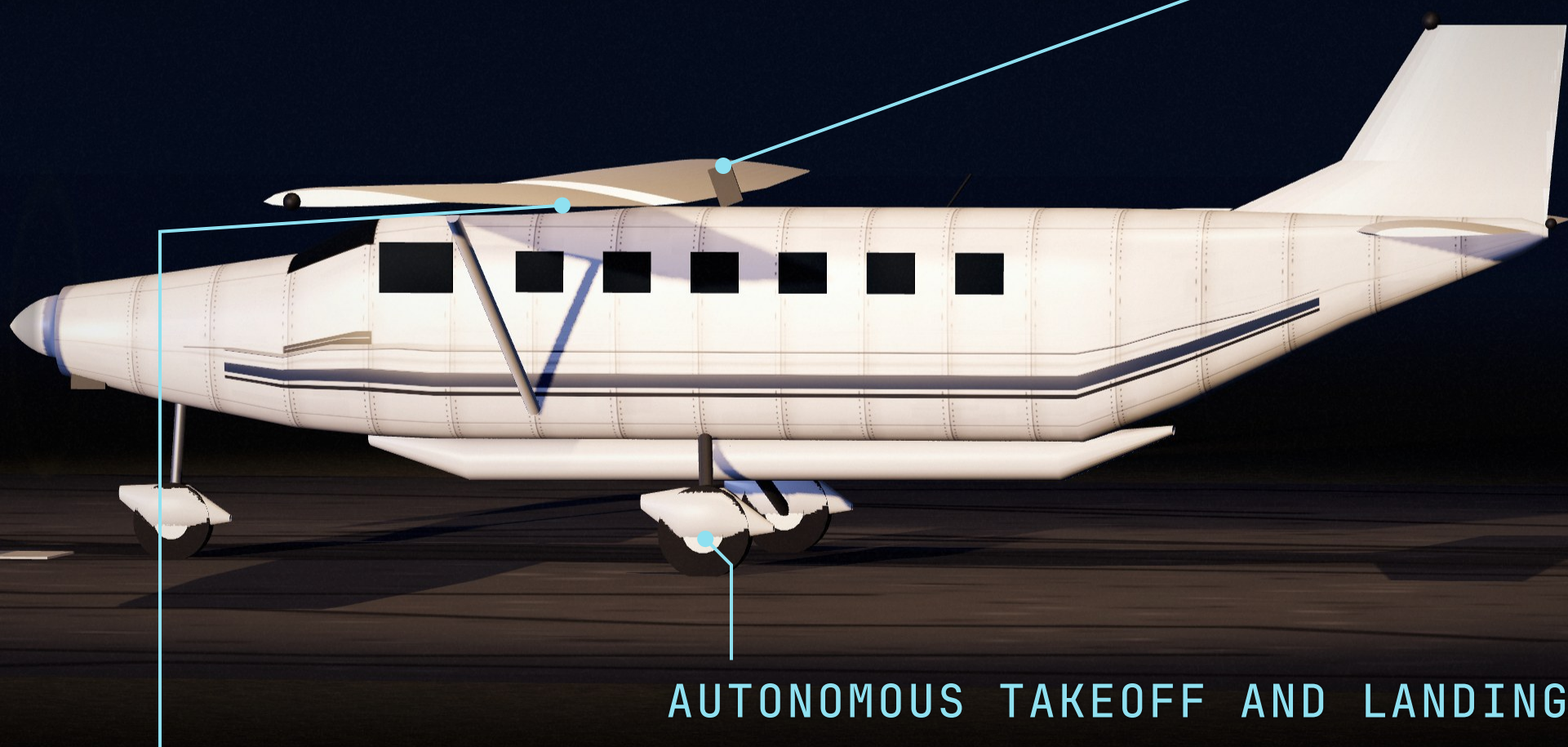


MERLIN'S CARAVAN

Three things Merlin says it showed

Merlin says the demonstration, narrated by its chief executive, showed the Merlin Pilot can safely and effectively perform responsibilities traditionally managed by human pilots. Its release calls its expectations forward-looking.

AI-POWERED AIR TRAFFIC CONTROL COMMUNICATIONS →



AUTONOMOUS TAKEOFF AND LANDING

IN-FLIGHT RE-PLANNING AND THREAT AVOIDANCE

What three releases print

A lamp is lit where a release says it. Only Merlin's names its Caravan, in a photo caption. None of the three says whether a pilot was aboard, and none prints a measured result.

PRINTS A RESULT

PILOT ABOARD

NAMES THE CARAVAN

TXDOT

FAA

MERLIN

Phase one flies traditional aircraft

TxDOT says the first phase tests helicopters and fixed-wing planes across the state, and that its first flights carry no passengers. The flights collect data and validate routes.



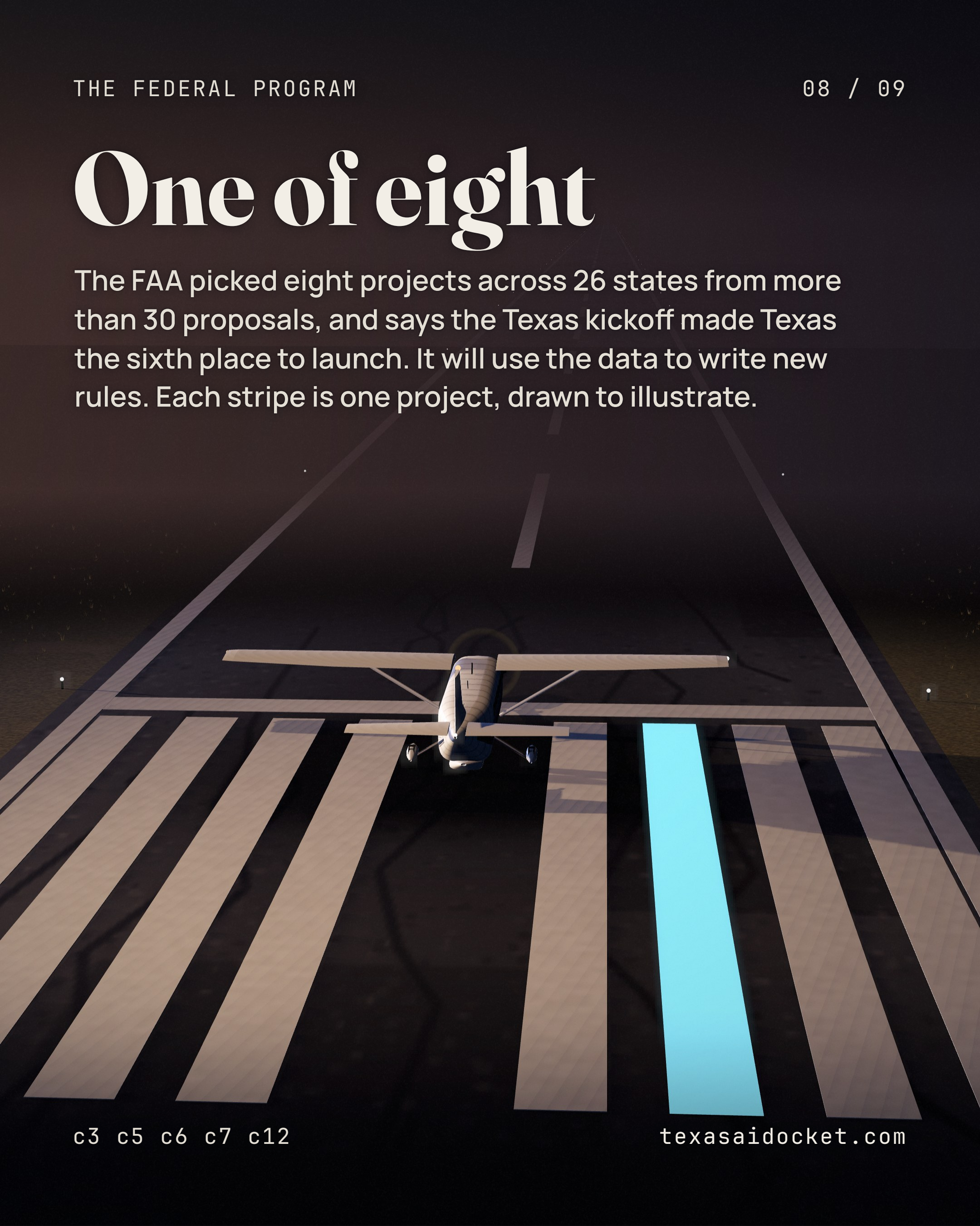
Dallas, Austin, San Antonio, then Houston

The FAA’s selection names Archer, BETA, Joby and Wisk as the Texas project’s partners, and Merlin is not among them. It says they will support regional flights connecting Dallas, Austin and San Antonio, and eventually Houston.



One of eight

The FAA picked eight projects across 26 states from more than 30 proposals, and says the Texas kickoff made Texas the sixth place to launch. It will use the data to write new rules. Each stripe is one project, drawn to illustrate.



28 days into the three years

TxDOT says the pilot runs in phases over three years, with passengers last. Counted from September 10th, October 8th is 28 days in, of 1,096. More test flights were planned through the rest of the year. None of the three releases says whether a pilot was aboard at the kickoff.

